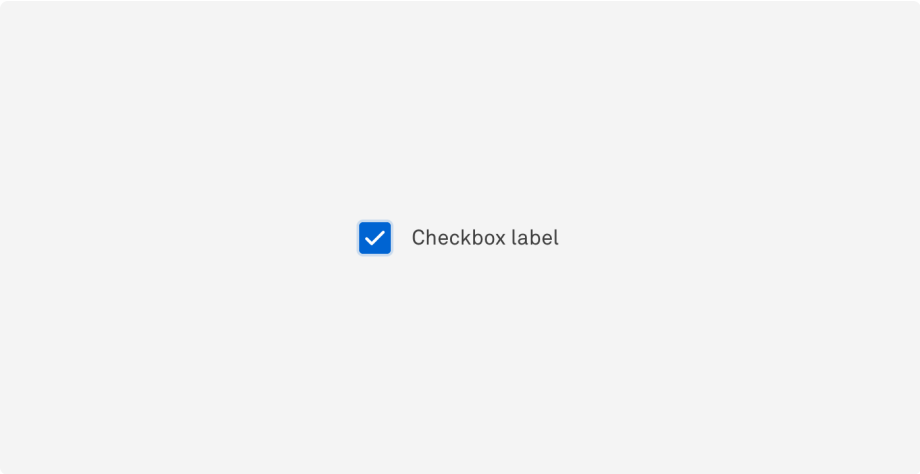
Checkbox

Created by Tony Wang, last modified by Genevieve Wang on 03 Mar 2021



Version

2

Availability

Web

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A standalone checkbox is a single selection control that allows a user to change a setting between selected or unselected state. The checkbox is always followed by a label that describes what will happen after users make a selection.

Useful Docs

- Writing Checkbox Labels
- When to Use Compact or Comfortable
- Using Images to Support Text Labels
- Checkbox & Radio UI Improvement
- Interaction for Selection Controls
- Don't use Checkbox for T&Cs

Specs

- Checkbox (Web)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground

Usage Guidelines

When to use a Standalone Checkbox:

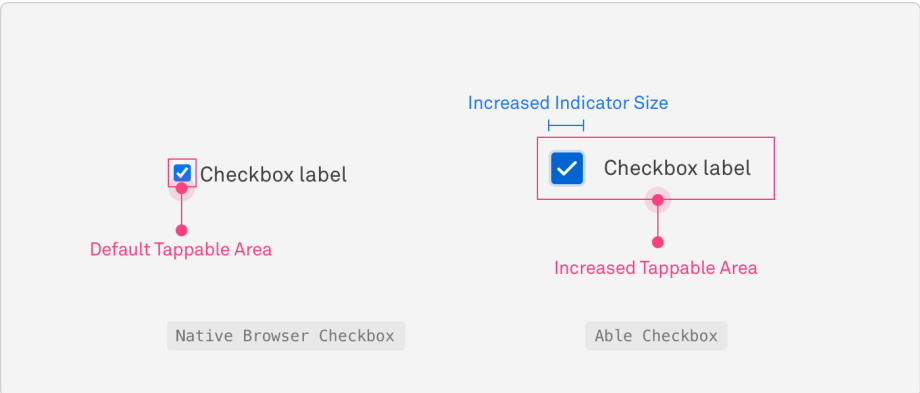
- Represent a single setting in Selected or Unselected state.
- Allow users to change a setting between Selected or Unselected state.
- Filter data either on a page or in a menu.

Examples of Standalone Checkbox usage:

- Remember username
- Save card details
- Trust this device

If your checkbox requires a Group Label to, use Checkbox Group with only one checkbox.

Design Rationale



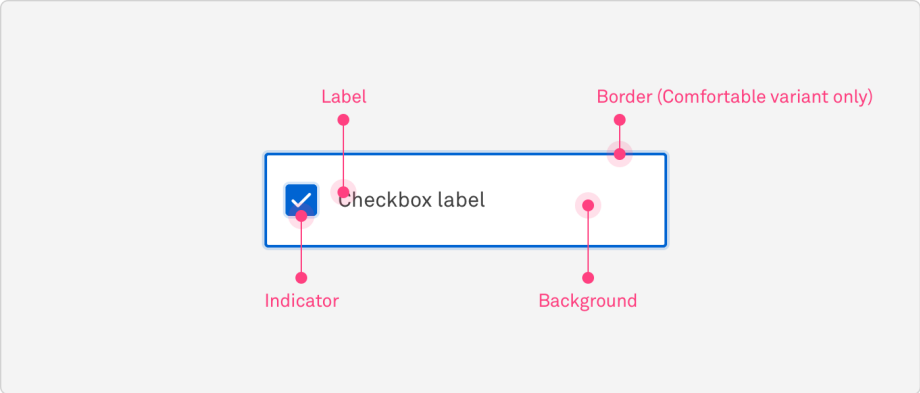
With the native checkbox controls, the indicator is small and the tappable area is limited to just the icon visual.

In order to improve the user interaction of our checkbox, we have:

- Increase the indicator size more than 200%
- Increase the tappable area to allow selection by tapping on the label (for touchscreen devices or mobility impaired users)

For more details behind this UI improvement, see Checkbox & Radio UI Improvement.

Anatomy

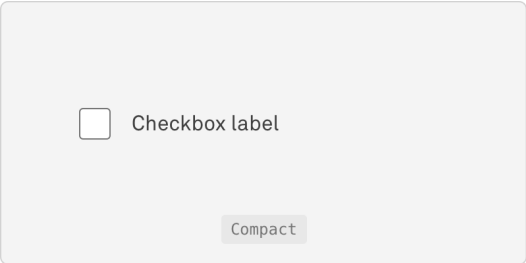


Variants

There are 2 variants to choose from — *Compact* and *Comfortable*.

For guidance on the which variant to use, see When to Use Compact or Comfortable.

Compact



The Compact variant is designed to present a quick and simple decision for the user. It will often be positioned near another UI control as a secondary action (e.g. 'Remember username' under sign in fields).

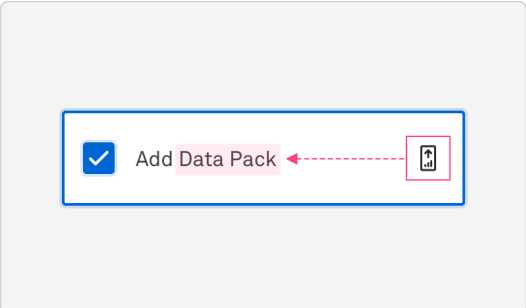
Comfortable

The Comfortable variant is designed to guide users to **make an important (or a complex) decision** by putting more emphasis on the option user is selecting.

Supporting Your Selection Options

In the Comfortable Group variant, you have the ability to:

Add a Supporting Image



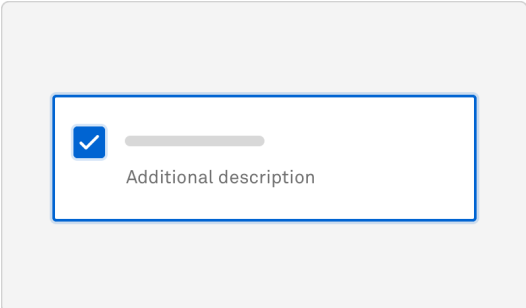
Adding a supporting Image can **help convey the radio option quickly to our users**.

To learn more about choosing a supporting image, see Using Images to Support Text Labels.

Image types that can be used in Checkbox:

- Icon in 24x24
- Pictogram in 56x56

Add an Additional Description



Additional description provides **more clarification on the options** you're providing.

For more guidance on additional description, see Checkbox Description in Content Guidelines.

Interaction States

There are 8 unique states — each communicates the state of the checkbox as users interact with it. To find out more details on the different states, see Interaction States.

Checkbox can be:

- Unselected

- Selected

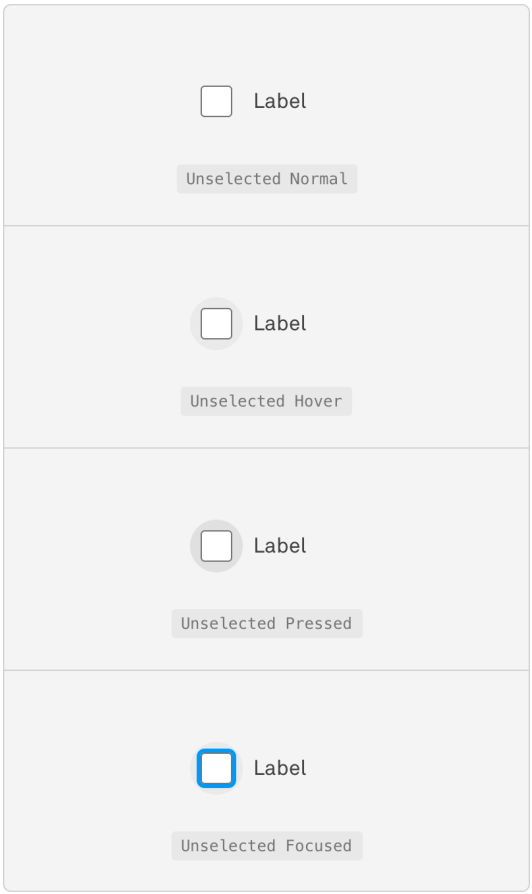
Each checkbox has 4 different states

1. Normal
2. Hover (Web only)
3. Pressed
4. Focused

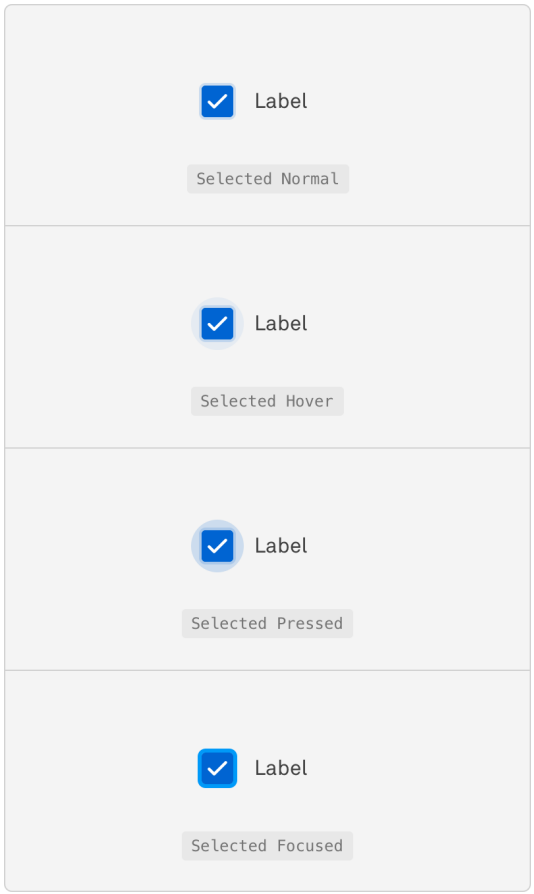
Keep in mind:

- '*Disabled state*' is not supported in Checkbox. See why we don't support disabled state.

Unselected States

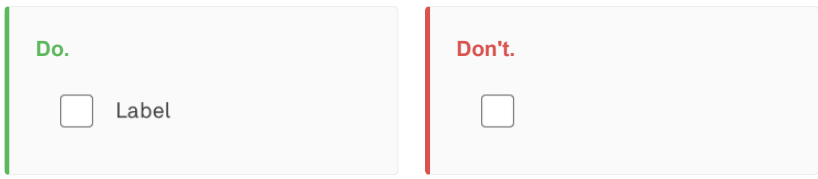


Selected States



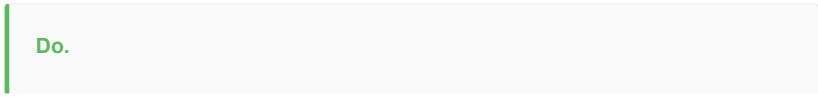
Best Practices

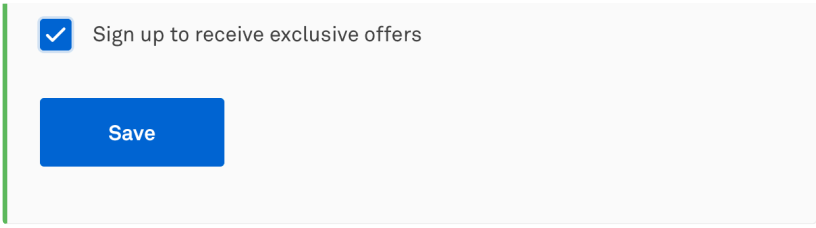
- **Selecting a checkbox will not apply the action immediately.**
  When user selects or deselects a checkbox, it should not take effect until the user performs a save/submit button. Exception is for filtering checkboxes, which can apply changes instantly.
- **Checkbox should always contain a label.**



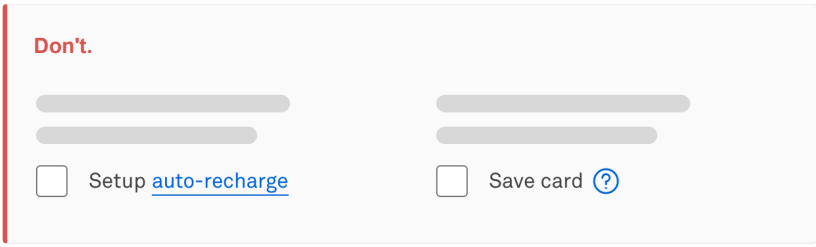
- **Use checkbox for changing a user setting, not for triggering an action.**

- **Pair checkbox with a submit button whenever possible.**
  The nature of a checkbox is to allow the user to change the status of a setting, not committing an action immediately. It's recommended to have a submit button on a page for user to commit their checkbox selection. Exception for when checkbox is used for filtering content.

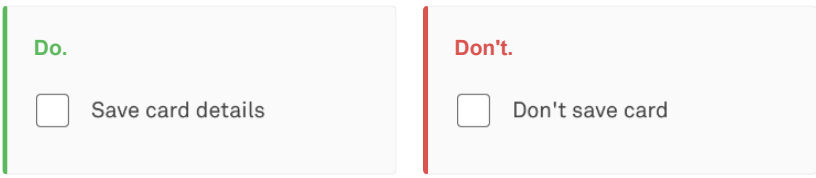




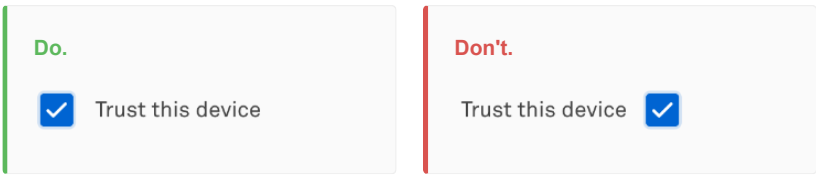
- **Don't add any interactive element (buttons / inline links) in the checkbox.**
  The checkbox itself is already selection control (label + box). By adding additional interactive elements such as Buttons or Inline Links, it not only affects the touch target of the checkbox control but also causes confusion to the users on the interaction behaviour - whether the checkbox will be selected when they click on the link inside.



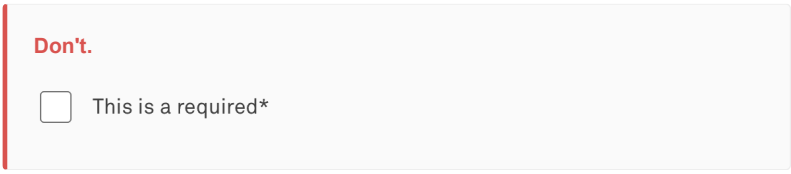
- **Use positive language and describe what will happen when checkbox is selected.**



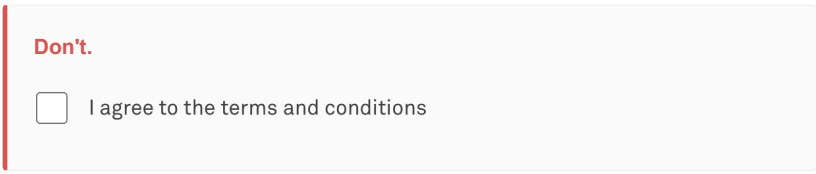
- **Don't disable checkboxes, user should be able to freely select or deselect a checkbox at any time.**
  See why we don't support disabled state.
- **When there is no visual affordance (e.g. line), the checkbox indicator should always appears on the left of the label.**



- **Don't use standalone checkbox to force user make a selection.**
  A standalone checkbox provides the user the ability to select or deselect an option (Nielsen Norman Group). It's not an ideal control to force the user to select/deselect an option. If there's any selection requirement, use Radio Group or Checkbox Group instead.



- **Don't use checkbox to get user's consent for Telstra products & services.**
  There are other approach to get consent from users without using Checkbox UI, see decision log. It's strongly recommended to avoid using checkbox for accepting Terms and Conditions or other legal documents in Telstra.



Content Guidelines

This section provides guidance on how to write effective copy for each text elements:

1. Checkbox Label
2. Checkbox Description

1. Checkbox Label

To write an effective label for a standalone checkbox, you should:

- Explain in the label what will happen if the user selects or deselects the checkbox.
- Keep label short and descriptive.

- Use sentence case.
- Always use positive language — User should know what will happen when they select the checkbox, not figure out what won't happen.

Do.

☐ Remember username

Don't.

☐ Don't remember username.

- Avoid declarative sentences and using personal pronouns, such as 'I', 'my' or 'you'.

Do.

☐ Trust this device

Don't.

☐ I trust this device.

- Not add any punctuation (commas, semicolons or full stops) in the label.

Do.

☐ Save payment details

Don't.

☐ Save your payment details:

2. Checkbox Description

Checkbox Description is optional to support a Checkbox Label if it will aid the user with their selection. Carefully consider whether additional description will add value to the user or whether the Checkbox Label is sufficient.

⚠ For accessibility, screen readers will read out the Checkbox Label and Checkbox Description together. Both should be kept succinct to avoid cognitive overload for the user.

- Only provide additional description if it will help users make a decision by understanding more about the option. Don't provide common or redundant information.

Do.

☐ Share app analytics
This will share your app usage and account data anonymously with us.

Don't.

☐ Save payment details
Your payment details will be saved to use for future payments.

- Avoid adding excessive description within the checkbox (e.g. fine print or product T&Cs).

Don't.

☐ Add Telstra TV
Get Netflix, Stan, Foxtel Now, live sport & catchup TV all in one place. Pause and rewind free-to-air TV. Search across apps and channels with a single voice remote. A minimum internet speed of 3.5Mbps is recommended. Antenna required to access free-to-air channels in your area. Subscription and data charges apply.

- Always use sentence case.
- Include proper punctuation when writing in full sentences.

Please refer to additional content guidelines listed in Telstra's Content Style Guide.

Accessibility Considerations

Checkbox is designed to meet the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined below. All requirements should be considered and understood when using the pattern.

⚠ indicates accessibility requirements will need to be met at time of usage, such as when authoring.

- ⚠ 1.1.1 Non-text Content (A) - Checkbox icons are decorative and will be ignored by assistive technology
- 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (A) - Checkbox contain a label that is programmatically associated with the field
- 1.4.3 Contrast Minimum (AA) - All text meets the 4.5:1 contrast ratio
- 1.4.4 Resize Text (AA) - When resized to 200%, text is not truncated
- 1.4.11 Non Text Contrast (AA) - Aspects of the checkbox required for identification meet the contrast ratio of 3:1
- 1.4.12 Text Spacing (AA) - Text spacing can be increased without loss of content
- 2.1.1 Keyboard (A) - Checkboxes are keyboard accessible
- 2.4.3 Focus Order (A) - Checkboxes follow a sequential focus order
- ⚠ 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (AA) Text fields have descriptive labels
- 2.4.7 Focus Visible (AA) - Checkbox has a clear visible focus state
- 2.5.3 Label in Name (A) - The accessible name of the checkbox matches the visible label
- 2.5.5 Target Size (AAA) - The touch target size is at least 48 x 48 (dp/pt/px)
- ⚠ 3.3.1 Error Identification (A) - Checkboxes that are mandatory can be determined in text and in code
- ⚠ 3.3.2 Labels or Instructions (A) - Labels and instructional text are clear and unambiguous
- ⚠ 3.3.3 Error Suggestion (AA) - Clear and unambiguous information is provided to help users correct input errors when they occur
- ⚠ 3.4.2 Consistent Identification (AA) - Checkboxes that capture the same data also contain the same label
- 4.1.1 Parsing (A) - Checkboxes use valid HTML/markup/code
- 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A) - Checkbox, labels, instructions and errors are marked up correctly to expose the correct name and role to assistive technology

Keyboard

Interaction	Keystrokes
Move keyboard focus to checkbox	TAB
Toggle checkbox on or off	SPACEBAR

- Users must be able to navigate to and interact with a checkbox using keyboard alone.
- A clear visible indicator should also be present when the checkbox has focus.

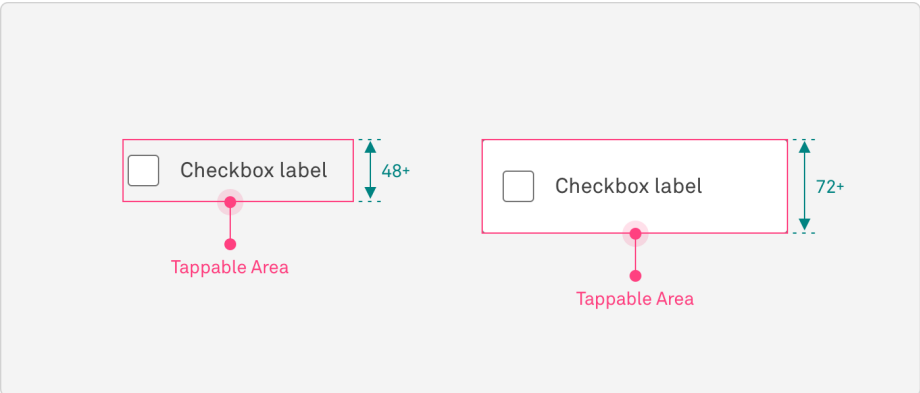
Screen Reader

Screen reader behaviour and the ordering of announcements will vary depending on the platform/browser/screen reader combinations being used.

On screen reader focus or toggling the state of checkbox, announcements must include:

- The **label** of the checkbox
- The **role** ie "checkbox" or "tickbox"
- The **state** of the checkbox, ie "Ticked", "Not Ticked", "Checked" or "Not Checked"

Interactions



Checkbox can be selected or deselected with:

- A mouse click on the indicator or the label
- A SPACE key on keyboard

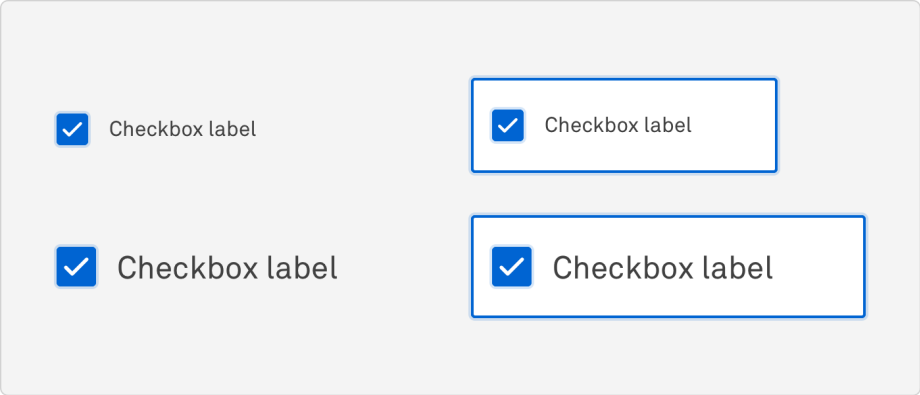
Tappable area:

- Compact checkbox has a minimum height of 48
- Comfortable checkbox has a minimum height of 72

Capabilities

Robust Layout.

Components are scaled automatically based on the font size and zoom level in user's browser settings.



Related Patterns

- Checkbox Group
- Multi Select Row
- Radio Group
- Single Select Row

No labels

Atlassian